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UAE Presidential Court

LEADERS AFFIRM UAE HAS OVERCOME CRISIS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Saturday met His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai. The leaders commended the effectiveness of the armed forces and the efforts of all military institutions and security services in safeguarding the nation's security, territorial integrity and the safety of its people and residents in the face of the Iranian terrorist attacks targeting the UAE. The leaders affirmed that the UAE has overcome the crisis with strength, resilience and determination, underscoring the country's ability to address challenges through the effectiveness of its institutions and the unity and cohesion of its society.

Dubai unifies real estate, residency services

Single system
aims to speed up
processes

DUBAI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

The General Directorate of Identity and Foreigners Affairs – Dubai (GDRFA Dubai), and the Dubai Land Department have signed a memorandum of understanding to bring real estate and residency services under one system.

The agreement, signed by Lieutenant General Mohammed Ahmed Al Marri and Omar

Hamad Bu Shehab, aims to simplify procedures and improve the overall experience for residents, investors and property owners.

Three key services

The deal will see three key services – Golden Residency, Retiree Residency and Property Residency – integrated into GDRFA Dubai's system. This means applicants will be able to complete their requests through a single channel instead of dealing with multiple authorities.

Officials said the move will cut waiting times, improve coordination and allow faster

decision-making. It will also support better data sharing between the two entities, helping create a smoother and more reliable process.

The initiative is part of a wider push to make government services more connected and easier to access, especially as demand grows in Dubai's real estate sector.

Authorities believe the step will strengthen trust in Dubai's property market and make it more attractive for investors. By linking residency options with real estate ownership, the city aims to offer greater stability and long-term value to those choosing to live and work here.

TRUMP ORDERS BLOCKADE OF HORMUZ AS TALKS COLLAPSE

Escalation threatens truce amid US–Iran tensions

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

President Donald Trump yesterday ordered a US naval blockade of the Strait of Hormuz following the collapse of peace talks with Iran, marking a major escalation that could test an already fragile ceasefire.

In social media posts and a Fox News interview, Trump said the 21-hour talks in Islamabad had gone “well” and that “most points were agreed to,” but accused Tehran of being “unyielding” on its nuclear programme and failing to reopen the strait – a key condition of the two-week truce.

Cutting off oil revenues

“Effective immediately, the United States Navy... will begin the process of BLOCKADING any and all ships trying to enter or leave the Strait of Hormuz,” he said on Truth Social.

Trump made clear the move was aimed at cutting off Iran's oil revenues.

“We're not going to let Iran

A key obstacle in the Islamabad talks is the belief on both sides that they have already won – and that time is on their side.

make money on selling oil to people that they like,” he said on Fox News. “It's going to be all or none – and that's the way it is.”

“Any Iranian who fires at us... will be BLOWN TO HELL!”

Trump said Britain and “a couple of other countries” could join the effort with minesweepers, and warned China with a 50 per cent tariff on its goods if it provides military support to Tehran. He also reiterated threats to strike Iranian power plants and energy infrastructure, saying US forces were “fully LOCKED AND LOADED” and would “finish up the little that is left of Iran” if needed.

UAE: Hormuz has never been Iran's to close

Meanwhile, Dr Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber, UAE Minister of Industry and Advanced Technol-

ogy, said nearly 800 commercial vessels were stranded, adding: “The Strait of Hormuz has never been Iran's to close or restrict.”

Earlier, US Vice-President JD Vance left Pakistan without a deal after talks with a delegation led by Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf – the highest-level engagement since 1979. Vance said negotiations failed because Iran rejected a “final and best offer”. “We'll see if the Iranians accept it,” he said. Ghalibaf countered that the US “ultimately failed to gain the trust” of Iran's delegation.

Pakistan's Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar said Islamabad would try to facilitate further dialogue, though neither side has indicated immediate next steps. “It is imperative that the parties continue to uphold their commitment to cease fire,” he said.

The collapse leaves Washington facing stark choices: Prolonged negotiations over Iran's nuclear programme, or renewed conflict that has already triggered one of the biggest energy disruptions in modern times and raised the prospect of a prolonged struggle over control of the Strait of Hormuz.

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